

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) | Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR) | Incident Response | Vulnerability Management

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security analyst with over five years of experience protecting large, complex enterprise environments across higher education and financial technology sectors. I specialise in monitoring, investigating and responding to cyber security alerts and incidents, with strong hands-on expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR), vulnerability management, and threat hunting. I have led incident response activities across the full lifecycle and have deep experience with Microsoft Azure security technologies, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) at scale, Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), and CrowdStrike Falcon. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a thorough understanding of security frameworks including NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, and CIS Controls. I am ready to bring this depth of operational and technical expertise to a senior analyst role within a leading professional services environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, detection engineering, alert triage, log correlation and investigation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Incident Response:** Full lifecycle incident management aligned to NIST 800-61 - detection, investigation, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned; IR playbook development
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus - risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Threat Hunting and Threat Intelligence:** Proactive hunting using MITRE ATT&CK framework gap analysis and threat intelligence to identify low-and-slow attacks not surfaced by automated alerts
- **Network and Perimeter Security:** Firewalls, Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS), Mimecast email security gateway, Check Point Harmony, web application firewall (WAF)
- **Microsoft Azure Security Technologies:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), MFA, Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM platform administration
- **Mobile Device and Application Management (MDM/MAM):** Microsoft Intune
- **Security Automation:** PowerShell scripting for Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows; Microsoft Sentinel automation rules
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Certifications:** Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP), CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Monitor, investigate and respond to cyber security alerts and incidents across the enterprise using Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, writing KQL detection rules and managing alert quality to maintain high-fidelity triage.
- Lead incident response activities end-to-end aligned to NIST 800-61, conducting root cause analysis, coordinating containment and eradication across technical teams, and producing post-incident reports with lessons-learned recommendations.

- Conduct proactive threat hunting exercises using MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping and threat intelligence to identify attacker activity not surfaced by automated alerting, converting findings into new detection rules.
- Manage vulnerability remediation programmes using Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io, risk-prioritising findings and tracking remediation to closure with infrastructure and application teams.
- Oversee penetration test finding management, working with third-party testers to validate scope, triage results, and drive remediation of critical and high-severity vulnerabilities within agreed timescales.
- Provide security guidance and review across infrastructure change projects, embedding security-by-design principles into new system deployments and major change initiatives.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access policies, MFA, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) to minimise identity attack surface across cloud and hybrid environments.
- Automate security operations workflows using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel automation rules, improving analyst productivity and response consistency on high-frequency alert types.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, configuring attack surface reduction rules, automated investigation and response, and custom detection policies to protect a large, distributed workforce.
- Conducted daily SIEM alert triage in Microsoft Sentinel, investigating security events using KQL queries and correlating data across endpoint, identity, email, and network log sources to identify and resolve threats.
- Monitored CrowdStrike Falcon EDR for endpoint-based threats, escalating confirmed incidents through the incident response lifecycle and maintaining detailed investigation documentation.
- Managed vulnerability management activities using Nessus, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised reports and working with system owners to track remediation, including post-remediation validation scanning.
- Performed threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK technique mappings and endpoint telemetry to proactively identify indicators of compromise and previously undetected attacker persistence mechanisms.
- Investigated Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) detections relating to Active Directory-based attacks including credential theft, Kerberoasting, and lateral movement.
- Managed firewall rules, Intrusion Detection and Prevention System (IDS/IPS) policies, and Mimecast email security gateway configurations in collaboration with the network and infrastructure teams.
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM platforms, governing privileged access and enforcing device compliance policies.
- Contributed to ISO 27001, CIS Controls, and NIST CSF security programme activities, supporting audit preparation and control evidence gathering.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / Financial Technology)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and managed security controls across cloud and SaaS infrastructure, including endpoint security, identity access management, and network security tooling.
- Monitored security alerts and conducted initial triage, escalating confirmed incidents for senior investigation and coordinating remediation with infrastructure and development teams.
- Managed Microsoft 365 security configuration including Conditional Access, MFA, and role-based access controls.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and patch management activities, maintaining visibility of the organisation's asset and vulnerability posture and tracking remediation of critical findings.
- Supported security quality assurance reviews, assessing system configurations against industry best practices and producing risk-based remediation recommendations.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) to an 8,000-user estate at UAL, delivering comprehensive endpoint detection, automated response, and attack surface reduction capability across a complex, geographically distributed environment.
- Developed and refined a portfolio of KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, significantly reducing false-positive rates and improving the quality of SIEM alerts reaching the analyst team.
- Led end-to-end incident response engagements for complex incidents including phishing campaigns and endpoint compromise, producing root cause analyses and lessons-learned reports that drove tangible detection improvements.
- Established a structured threat hunting programme using MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, proactively identifying previously undetected attacker activity and converting findings into new SIEM detection rules.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), eliminating uncontrolled privileged access across the estate and establishing a fully auditable privileged session management capability.
- Maintained Cyber Essentials+ certification through ongoing vulnerability management, access control governance, and patch management oversight, supporting UAL's information security compliance posture.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)